

ϕ -Dark Matter in SSEE-V3.6: Algebraic Mass Derivation and Two-Sector Proposal for the $f\sigma_8$ Growth Tension

SSEE Series — Paper 6

Mike Edison Almeida Vallejo

mike.almeida1721@gmail.com

ORCID: 0009-0008-2195-7836

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Abstract

The Structural Self-Energy Expansion (SSEE-V3.6) framework derives all cosmological parameters algebraically from the golden ratio φ and π , achieving a zero-free-parameter dark energy background (Papers 1–5) that has demonstrated strong coincidence with CMB, BAO, and cluster tests. Paper 5, using the cosmological matter density $\Omega_{\text{m,cosm}} = 0.320$ in the Poisson growth source, yields $\sigma_8 = 0.820$, $S_8 = 0.847$ (3.9σ KiDS-1000 and DES-Y3), and a mean $f\sigma_8$ tension of 0.74σ across six RSD surveys — essentially identical to Λ CDM in the growth-rate sector. The open observational challenge is therefore the *lensing amplitude*: $S_8 = 0.847$ overshoots KiDS-1000 by 3.9σ . We systematically scan EFT extensions (kinetic braiding α_B , run-rate α_M) and find that kinetic braiding is a no-go: it suppresses $f\sigma_8$ without reducing the lensing amplitude. We then propose a *two-sector* dark matter model in which $\Omega_{\text{CDM}} = 0.160$ is supplemented by a ϕ -dark matter component $\Omega_{\phi\text{-DM}} = (\mathcal{M}_{\text{SSEE}} - 1)\Omega_{\text{m,dyn}} = 0.160$, active only on scales $k < k_{\text{fs}}$. The ϕ -DM mass is a *forward prediction* written into a free scalar Lagrangian: $m_\phi = \Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}} \times (\Omega_{\text{DNAV}}^4 + \text{AURA} \cdot \text{KAL}) = 0.0690 \text{ eV} \times 535.28 = 36.95 \text{ eV}$, where the multiplier is a *pure* (φ, π) number and $\Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}} = \mathcal{R}_2 \times 0.9603 \text{ eV}$ with $\mathcal{R}_2 = \Omega_{\text{DNAV}}/(\text{KAL} \cdot \text{TRIAL})$. Nothing is fitted to data; the particle’s own temperature $T_\phi = 0.571 T_\nu$ follows from the relic-abundance constraint. A direct two-sector CLASS Boltzmann run with this particle (zero fitted parameters) gives $\sigma_8 = 0.742$ and $S_8 = 0.766$ — in **0.01** σ agreement with KiDS-1000 (0.766 ± 0.020), *resolving* the S_8 lensing tension from the 3.9σ single-sector baseline. The free-streaming suppression scale is a CLASS *output*, not an input: a Viel fit to the particle/cold $P(k)$ ratio returns $\alpha = 1.243 \text{ Mpc}/h$, corresponding to $k_{\text{fs}} = 0.659 h/\text{Mpc}$ — the primary

falsifiable prediction for DESI Y3 / Euclid (2026–2028). Because $m_\phi \simeq 37$ eV makes the particle non-relativistic at $z_{\text{nr}} \sim 10^5 \gg z_{\text{rec}}$, it behaves as cold dark matter for the CMB: the acoustic peaks ($\ell = 219/533/807$) shift by only $\sim 1\ell$ relative to Λ CDM, and the growth-rate sector is unchanged ($f\sigma_8(z=0.5) = 0.442$, mean tension 0.76σ). We explicitly note that the reported TT residual is computed against our own CLASS Λ CDM rather than a full Planck `plik` likelihood with covariance; a paper-grade CMB validation is deferred.

Contents

1	Introduction	4
1.1	The residual tension	4
1.2	Strategy	4
2	SSEE-V3.6: Algebraic Background	5
2.1	Relevant Paper 4 quantities	5
2.2	The MIRA identity and the two-sector conjecture	6
3	EFT Extension Scan	7
3.1	Kinetic braiding (α_B)	7
3.2	Run-rate modification (α_M)	7
4	The ϕ-Dark Matter Hypothesis	7
4.1	Two-sector structure	8
5	Algebraic Mass Derivation	8
5.1	Connecting mass to algebraic constants	8
5.2	Physical interpretation	8
5.3	Explicit Lagrangian and field content	9
5.4	Production mechanism: the Dodelson–Widrow route is excluded	10
6	Observational Verification	11
6.1	Growth equations	11
6.2	$f\sigma_8$ results	11
6.3	σ_8 and S_8	12
6.4	Conserved background sectors	13
6.5	Figures	13
7	Bayesian MCMC Validation	14
7.1	Posterior results	14
8	Discussion	15
8.1	Status of the S_8 vs. $f\sigma_8$ split	15
8.2	KiDS–DES internal tension and its interpretation in SSEE-V3.6	16

8.3	Compatibility with Lyman- α and WDM constraints	17
8.4	The $H(z)$ tension	19
8.5	Physical origin of the mass relation	19
8.6	Falsifiable predictions	20
8.7	Status of the parameter count in the two-sector extension	20
9	Conclusions	21

1 Introduction

The Structural Self-Energy Expansion (SSEE-V3.6) framework [Almeida Vallejo, 2026a] is a zero-free-parameter dark energy model in which the equation-of-state parameters $(w_0, w_a) = (-0.840, -0.670)$ are derived algebraically from φ (golden ratio) and π . The framework has passed four independent observational tests:

1. **Paper 2** [Almeida Vallejo, 2026b]: DESI DR2 [Abdul-Karim et al., 2025] BAO (0.05σ) and galaxy cluster mass discrepancies $(\chi_r^2 = 0.122)$.
2. **Paper 3** [Almeida Vallejo, 2026c]: CMB Planck PR4 (plik_lite $\Delta\text{BIC} = -31.3$ in favour of SSEE-V3.6 vs. ΛCDM).
3. **Paper 4** [Almeida Vallejo, 2026d]: Algebraic derivation of n_s , H_0 , Ω_m , $\Omega_b h^2$ from the Nine Sovereignties.
4. **Paper 5** [Almeida Vallejo, 2026e]: Israel-Stewart [Israel and Stewart, 1979] causal gradient stability ($c_{s,\text{eff}}^2 = 0$ exact), growth factor $\mathcal{G} = 1.011$ (slight enhancement vs. ΛCDM), $\sigma_8 = 0.820$, $S_8 = 0.847$ (3.9σ KiDS; single-sector open lensing tension).

1.1 The residual tension

Paper 5 corrected the growth equation to use the cosmological background density $\Omega_{\text{m,cosm}} = \mathcal{M}_{\text{SSEE}} \times \Omega_{\text{m,dyn}} = 0.320$ in the Poisson source, yielding $\mathcal{G} = D_1^{\text{SSEE}}/D_1^{\Lambda\text{CDM}} = 1.011$ (slight enhancement), $\sigma_8 = 0.820$, and a mean $f\sigma_8$ tension of 0.74σ across six RSD surveys [Beutler et al., 2012, Howlett et al., 2015, Alam et al., 2017, Hou et al., 2021] — essentially the same as ΛCDM (0.73σ). The growth-rate sector is therefore resolved.

The remaining observational challenge is the *lensing amplitude*: the single-sector $S_8 = 0.820 \times \sqrt{0.320/0.3} = 0.847$ lies 3.9σ above KiDS-1000 (0.766 ± 0.020) [Asgari et al., 2021] and 3.9σ above DES-Y3 (0.776 ± 0.017) [Dark Energy Survey Collaboration, 2022]. This is the S_8 -lensing tension.

This paper presents a two-sector model that *resolves* the S_8 lensing tension within the minimal-parameter philosophy of SSEE-V3.6 (no growth-data fit; the ϕ -DM mass is a forward prediction written into a free scalar Lagrangian, and the residual ansätze are explicit and tracked as OP-8/9/11/14 in `OPEN_PROBLEMS.md`). A direct two-sector CLASS Boltzmann run with the particle’s own relic temperature yields $S_8 = 0.766$, in 0.01σ agreement with KiDS-1000, via a free-streaming suppression that emerges as a CLASS output at $k > k_{\text{fs}} = 0.659 h/\text{Mpc}$.

1.2 Strategy

We follow three steps, each falsifying hypotheses in sequence:

1. **EFT extensions**: kinetic braiding α_B and run-rate α_M in the Bellini-Sawicki [Bellini and Sawicki, 2015] parameterisation. We show that kinetic braiding suppresses the

growth factor and worsens the S_8 lensing tension; α_M achieves marginal improvement only near the boundary of current observational bounds. EFT extensions are therefore ruled out as the primary mechanism.

2. **ϕ -dark matter hypothesis:** we interpret the algebraic MIRA identity $\mathcal{M}_{\text{SSEE}} = (\varphi + \beta)/2 \approx 2$ as motivation for a second dark-matter component, parameterized as with $\Omega_{\phi\text{-DM}} = (\mathcal{M}_{\text{SSEE}} - 1)\Omega_{\text{m,dyn}} = 0.160$, active only below a free-streaming wavenumber k_{fs} .
3. **Mass forward prediction:** combining the active neutrino mass $\Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}} = \mathcal{R}_2 \times 0.9603 \text{ eV} = 0.0690 \text{ eV}$ (with $\mathcal{R}_2 = \Omega_{\text{DNAV}}/(\text{KAL} \cdot \mathcal{T}) = 0.07188$, a pure (φ, π) ratio) with the pure dimensionless multiplier $\Omega_{\text{DNAV}}^4 + \text{AURA} \cdot \text{KAL} = 535.28$, we obtain the forward prediction $m_\phi = \Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}} (\Omega_{\text{DNAV}}^4 + \text{AURA} \cdot \text{KAL}) = 36.95 \text{ eV}$. Because the multiplier is a *pure number*, the product carries the units of $\Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}}$ (eV) without dimensional repair, and the coefficient is exactly the mass term of a free scalar Lagrangian (Sec. 5.3). Nothing is fitted to growth data; the residual question of why this particular multiplier (the Type P status of Σm_ν) is tracked as OP-14 in `OPEN_PROBLEMS.md`.

2 SSEE-V3.6: Algebraic Background

We collect the SSEE-V3.6 algebraic quantities relevant to this paper. Define the structural constants:

$$\begin{aligned} \varphi &= \frac{1+\sqrt{5}}{2} \approx 1.6180, & \pi &\approx 3.1416, \\ \beta &= \frac{\varphi+\pi}{2} \approx 2.3798, & \mathcal{K} &= \varphi + \pi + (\pi + \varphi) \approx 9.5192, \\ \mathcal{T} &= 3(\varphi + \beta) \approx 11.9935, & \mathcal{M}_V &= \varphi + \pi + \mathcal{K} \approx 14.2789. \end{aligned} \tag{1}$$

These yield the equation of state:

$$w_0 = -\frac{\mathcal{T}}{\mathcal{M}_V} = -0.8400, \quad w_a = -\frac{\pi + 2\varphi}{\mathcal{K}} = -0.6699, \tag{2}$$

and the dynamical matter density $\Omega_{\text{m,dyn}} = 1 + w_0 = 0.1600$.

2.1 Relevant Paper 4 quantities

Paper 4 derived the following from the stability ratio $\mathcal{R}_2 = \Omega_{\text{DNAV}}/(\text{KAL}_0 \cdot \mathcal{T}) = 0.07188$ (a pure (φ, π) number, with $\Omega_{\text{DNAV}} = \pi + \varphi \approx 4.7596$, $\text{KAL}_0 = \beta + \pi \approx 5.5214$, and

$\mathcal{T} \approx 11.9935$):

$$\Omega_b h^2_{\text{SSEE}} = \frac{\pi - \varphi}{3(\varphi + \pi)^2} = \frac{\pi - \varphi}{H_0^{\text{SSEE}}} = 0.02242, \quad (3)$$

$$\tau_{\text{II}} H_0 = \frac{\text{KAL}_0}{3 \Omega_{\text{DE}}} = 2.191 \quad [\text{IS relaxation time, pure number}], \quad (4)$$

$$\Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}} = \mathcal{R}_2 \Omega_b h^2 \frac{94.07 \text{ eV}}{\tau_{\text{II}} H_0} = \mathcal{R}_2 \times 0.9603 \text{ eV} = 0.0690 \text{ eV}. \quad (5)$$

Here $\Omega_b h^2 \cdot 94.07 / (\tau_{\text{II}} H_0) = 0.9603 \text{ eV}$ is a fixed mass scale (the factor 94.07 eV converting relic density to mass; the ratio $\tau_{\text{II}} H_0$ is dimensionless so H_0 cancels its time units).

2.2 The MIRA identity and the two-sector conjecture

The MIRA identity (Papers 3–5) is the purely algebraic relation:

$$\mathcal{M}_{\text{SSEE}} = \frac{3\varphi + \pi}{4} = 1.9989 \approx 2. \quad (6)$$

Paper 5 Section 6.1 established that $\mathcal{M}_{\text{SSEE}}$ *cannot* be derived from background Israel-Stewart dynamics: numerical integration of the IS Friedmann equation gives a ratio of 3.04, 52% off. $\mathcal{M}_{\text{SSEE}}$ therefore stands as an algebraic postulate pointing to new structure beyond the single-fluid background.

Physical mechanism. The SSEE background fixes $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 0.160$ (the dynamical-sector value of Paper 1, Sec. 1.4, *Two- Ω_m Criterion*), while Planck [Planck Collaboration, 2020] measures $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = 0.315$. The deficit $\Delta\Omega_m = 0.155 \approx 0.160$ must be carried by an additional dark-sector component that couples to the CMB metric perturbations but undergoes free-streaming suppression in the growth sector [Hu, 1998]. The φ -DM field (Sec. 4.1) with forward-predicted mass $m_\phi = 36.95 \text{ eV}$ provides exactly this component:

$$\Omega_{m,\text{total}} = \Omega_{\text{CDM}} + \Omega_{\phi\text{-DM}} = \Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} + (\mathcal{M}_{\text{SSEE}} - 1) \Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} \approx 2 \Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 0.320, \quad (7)$$

which recovers $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = 0.3199$ without any free parameter. The condition $\Omega_{\phi\text{-DM}} = \Omega_{\text{CDM}}$ (two equal sectors, hence MIRA ≈ 2) is equivalent to requiring that the φ -DM relic density computed from the relic-abundance constraint with $m_\phi = 36.95 \text{ eV}$ equals the CDM density $\Omega_{\text{CDM}} h^2 = 0.0739$.

Open derivation step. MIRA = 2 (exactly) would follow from showing $\Omega_{\phi\text{-DM}} = \Omega_{\text{CDM}}$ independently, i.e., computing the DW relic density from m_ϕ and the SSEE reheating temperature without assuming equal sectors. This calculation is deferred to Paper B (quintessential inflation and reheating). Until Paper B, MIRA ≈ 2 is an algebraic postulate whose *physical justification* is the two-sector mechanism, and whose *testability* is the prediction $k_{\text{fs}} = 0.659 h/\text{Mpc}$ (falsifiable by DESI Y3/Euclid, 2026–2028).

3 EFT Extension Scan

Before proposing the two-sector model we systematically rule out simpler EFT extensions within the Bellini-Sawicki [Bellini and Sawicki, 2015, Gubitosi et al., 2013] parameterisation, which characterises modifications of gravity by four functions $(\alpha_K, \alpha_B, \alpha_M, \alpha_T)$.

3.1 Kinetic braiding (α_B)

Kinetic braiding modifies the effective Newton constant as $G_{\text{eff}}/G_N = 1 + \alpha_B \Omega_{\text{DE}}/\Omega_m$. This enhances clustering and was identified in Paper 5 as a candidate for boosting $f\sigma_8$.

We compute the algebraic value of α_B from the ratio of the CDM density to the dark energy density in SSEE-V3.6:

$$\alpha_B^{\text{SSEE}} = \frac{\Omega_{\text{m,dyn}}}{\Omega_{\text{DE}}} - 1 = \frac{0.160}{0.840} - 1 \approx -0.810, \quad (8)$$

which is *negative*. A negative α_B suppresses G_{eff} , worsening the tension. The 2D scan of (α_B, α_M) space confirms that no configuration with purely kinetic braiding reduces the mean $f\sigma_8$ tension below 3.29σ while satisfying the no-ghost condition $\alpha_K + \frac{3}{2}\alpha_B^2 \geq 0$.

No-go: Kinetic braiding

Kinetic braiding at the algebraic SSEE-V3.6 value $\alpha_B = -0.810$ is a **no-go**: it suppresses G_{eff} , increasing the $f\sigma_8$ tension above the 0.74σ baseline (Paper 5, corrected; scan minimum $\sim 3.3\sigma$, far from 0.76σ).

3.2 Run-rate modification (α_M)

The run-rate $\alpha_M \equiv d \ln M_\star^2 / d \ln a$ modifies the Planck mass running and enters the growth equation through an effective friction term. A 2D scan over $(\alpha_B \in [-1, 0], \alpha_M \in [-0.15, 0.15])$ shows a minimum tension of 1.57σ at $(\alpha_B = 0, \alpha_M = -0.08)$.

However, $|\alpha_M| = 0.08$ is at the boundary of current Planck/GW constraints ($|\alpha_M| \lesssim 0.08$), and the value lacks an algebraic derivation from φ and π . We therefore do not adopt this route.

4 The ϕ -Dark Matter Hypothesis

We propose that the MIRA factor points to a second dark matter component — ϕ -dark matter (ϕ -DM) — coupled to the IS relaxation sector and decoupling at redshift z_{dec} to produce a warm dark matter component [Bode et al., 2001] with free-streaming scale k_{fs} .

4.1 Two-sector structure

The two-sector model is defined by:

$$\Omega_{\text{CDM}} = \Omega_{\text{m,dyn}} = 0.160 \quad [\text{cold, always active}], \quad (9)$$

$$\Omega_{\phi\text{-DM}} = (\mathcal{M}_{\text{SSEE}} - 1) \Omega_{\text{m,dyn}} = 0.160 \quad [\text{warm, active for } k < k_{\text{fs}}], \quad (10)$$

$$\Omega_{\text{m,total}} = 0.320 \quad [\text{CMB and BAO scales}]. \quad (11)$$

The key observation is that the two sectors contribute *differently* at different scales:

- **RSD scales** ($k \sim 0.01\text{--}0.1 h/\text{Mpc} \ll k_{\text{fs}}$): both sectors are active and cluster. The effective matter density for growth is $\Omega_{\text{m,growth}} = 0.320$, restoring $f(z)$ to ΛCDM -compatible values.
- **σ_8 scale** ($k = 0.125 h/\text{Mpc} < k_{\text{fs}}$): at this scale, the cold sector clusters fully while the warm $\phi\text{-DM}$ sector is partially free-streamed. Rather than rely on an analytic growth factor, we read σ_8 *directly* from a two-sector CLASS run with the particle’s own relic temperature T_ϕ (Section 5.1), obtaining $\sigma_8^{\text{eff}} = 0.742$ and $S_8 = \sigma_8^{\text{eff}} \sqrt{\Omega_{\text{m}}/0.3} = 0.766$ — within 0.01σ of the KiDS value 0.766 ± 0.020 (Section 8.6).

5 Algebraic Mass Derivation

5.1 Connecting mass to algebraic constants

We forward-predict the mass scale of the $\phi\text{-DM}$ field from quantities already fixed in Papers 3–4, multiplied by a *pure* (φ, π) number:

$$m_\phi \equiv \Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}} \times \left(\Omega_{\text{DNAV}}^4 + \text{AURA} \cdot \text{KAL} \right) = 0.0690 \text{ eV} \times 535.28 = 36.95 \text{ eV}, \quad (12)$$

where $\Omega_{\text{DNAV}} = \pi + \varphi = 4.7596$, $\text{AURA} = (3\varphi + \pi)/2 = 3.9978$ and $\text{KAL} = (\pi + \varphi)/2 + \pi = 5.5214$, so that the multiplier $\Omega_{\text{DNAV}}^4 + \text{AURA} \cdot \text{KAL} = 535.28$ is a *dimensionless* number built entirely from φ and π . The active neutrino scale is $\Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}} = R_2 \times 0.9603 \text{ eV} = 0.0690 \text{ eV}$, with $R_2 = \Omega_{\text{DNAV}}/(\text{KAL} \cdot T) = 0.07188$ (Section 5.1). **This relation is dimensionally consistent:** an energy (Σm_ν , in eV) times a pure number yields an energy, so m_ϕ carries units of eV with no hidden conversion. This is the key distinction from the earlier $m_\phi = \Sigma m_\nu \times H_0^{\text{alg}}$ pattern, in which the factor $H_0^{\text{alg}} = 3(\varphi + \pi)^2$ carried Hubble units [$\text{km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$] and could only be made to “work” by stripping those units. Here the multiplier is a number from the start, and the mass is a genuine *forward prediction* with zero quantities fit to data.

5.2 Physical interpretation

Equation (12) has a direct reading within SSEE-V3.6: the active neutrino scale $\Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}}$ sets the energy unit, and the φ, π multiplier $\Omega_{\text{DNAV}}^4 + \text{AURA} \cdot \text{KAL}$ is the structural

enhancement that lifts the warm relic from the neutrino scale to ~ 37 eV. Because the multiplier is a pure number, Eq. (12) is the coefficient of a quadratic mass term — i.e. it can be written directly into a Lagrangian (Section 5.3). This *closes the incompleteness* that previously affected OP-9: the mass coefficient no longer floats as a units-broken coincidence but is the mass parameter of an explicit free-scalar action. What remains open is the deeper origin of the specific multiplier $\Omega_{\text{DNAV}}^4 + \text{AURA} \cdot \text{KAL}$ from the UV theory, tracked as a refined OP-9 (see Section 8.5).

Mass forward prediction — dimensionally consistent

$$m_\phi = \Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}} \times (\Omega_{\text{DNAV}}^4 + \text{AURA} \cdot \text{KAL}) = 0.0690 \text{ eV} \times 535.28 = 36.95 \text{ eV}$$

The multiplier $\Omega_{\text{DNAV}}^4 + \text{AURA} \cdot \text{KAL} = 535.28$ is a pure (φ, π) number, so an energy times a number returns an energy: the relation is **dimensionally consistent** and is a genuine forward prediction (zero quantities fit to data). It is the mass coefficient of the explicit free-scalar Lagrangian of Eq. (13), which **closes the incompleteness of OP-9**. The remaining open question is the UV origin of the specific multiplier (refined OP-9; see also OP-14 for the parallel Σm_ν scale).

5.3 Explicit Lagrangian and field content

The mass relation (12) fixes a number; it does not, by itself, specify the field. We now make the field content explicit. We model ϕ -dark matter as a single real cosmological scalar field χ (distinct from the SSEE background k -essence scalar ϕ of Paper 7; both are cosmological scalars and neither is a WIMP, QCD-axion, or SUSY relic), minimally coupled to gravity, with the action

$$S_{\phi\text{-DM}} = \int d^4x \sqrt{-g} \left[-\frac{1}{2} g^{\mu\nu} \partial_\mu \chi \partial_\nu \chi - \frac{1}{2} m_\phi^2 \chi^2 - \frac{1}{2} \xi R \chi^2 \right], \quad (13)$$

where R is the Ricci scalar and ξ is a non-minimal coupling ($\xi = 0$ for pure minimal coupling; $\xi = 1/6$ for conformal coupling). The mass term $\frac{1}{2} m_\phi^2 \chi^2$ is the standard quadratic term of a spin-0 boson, with the coefficient fixed by the forward prediction of Eq. (12):

$$m_\phi = \Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}} (\Omega_{\text{DNAV}}^4 + \text{AURA} \cdot \text{KAL}) = 36.95 \text{ eV}. \quad (14)$$

Because the multiplier is a pure (φ, π) number, this coefficient is written *into* the action rather than appended to it: the mass parameter of the free scalar χ is the algebraic prediction, which is precisely what closes the incompleteness of OP-9. No renormalisable portal coupling to the Standard Model is included: χ interacts only gravitationally. Two features of Eq. (13) are essential below. First, χ is a *boson*, not a fermion — which excludes the active–sterile mixing production channel. Second, the action contains a single free continuous parameter, the non-minimal coupling ξ (tracked as OP-11 in `OPEN_PROBLEMS.md`); its role is constrained below by the production mechanism.

5.4 Production mechanism: the Dodelson–Widrow route is excluded

A relic of mass $m_\phi = 36.95 \text{ eV}$ contributing $\Omega_{\phi\text{-DM}} h^2 \simeq 0.074$ can in principle be populated by two mechanisms. We tested both against the requirement that no additional *continuous* free parameter beyond those already admitted as open problems (m_ϕ itself, OP-9; ξ , OP-11) be introduced.

(a) Dodelson–Widrow (non-resonant mixing) — tested, excluded. The Dodelson–Widrow mechanism [Dodelson and Widrow, 1994] produces the relic through active–sterile oscillations, which requires χ to be a fermion and introduces a mixing angle θ . Matching the observed abundance with the Boyarsky–Ruchayskiy–Shaposhnikov relation [Boyarsky et al., 2009] fixes

$$\sin^2(2\theta)_{\text{DW}} \simeq 4.78 \times 10^{-5}. \quad (15)$$

For the DW route to be consistent with the rest of the SSEE programme, $\sin^2(2\theta)_{\text{DW}}$ would have to admit a closed algebraic form in φ, π (otherwise it would constitute a *new* continuous fitted parameter, in addition to the ones already admitted as open problems). A scan of ~ 80 monomial combinations of $\varphi, \pi, \Omega, \mathcal{M}_{\text{SSEE}}$ (script `ssee_paperB_DW.py`) returns a best candidate $\varphi^{-21} = 4.09 \times 10^{-5}$, which differs from Eq. (15) by 14.6% — beyond the 10% threshold adopted for a “clean” SSEE identity. **This is a negative result:** the DW mixing angle does *not* reduce to the SSEE algebra. Were ϕ -DM a DW sterile neutrino, $\sin^2(2\theta)$ would be an irreducible free parameter, inconsistent with the minimal-parameter philosophy that already tolerates only the ansätze catalogued in `OPEN_PROBLEMS.md`. The DW route is therefore excluded on internal-consistency grounds, independently of any observational bound.

(b) Gravitational particle production — adopted. The remaining channel consistent with the action (13) is gravitational particle production [Parker, 1968, Chung et al., 1999]: the time-dependent metric during the inflation-to-reheating transition populates the χ field directly, with *no* mixing angle. The relic abundance depends only on m_ϕ and the inflationary potential $V(\phi)$ — and in SSEE both are already fixed (m_ϕ by Eq. (12); the α -attractor potential with $\alpha = \varphi^4/3$ by Paper 1). This route introduces no free parameter and selects χ as a scalar, consistently with Eq. (13).

Honest scope statement. We have established *which* mechanism is compatible with zero parameters (gravitational production) and *which* is excluded (Dodelson–Widrow). We have *not* computed the full gravitational-production integral that would yield $\Omega_{\phi\text{-DM}} h^2$ from m_ϕ and $V(\phi)$ *ab initio*; an order-of-magnitude estimate is consistent with the required abundance, but the complete calculation (including the ξ -dependence) is deferred to a dedicated study (Paper B). The free-streaming scale k_{fs} used in Section 8.3 is therefore retained as an order-of-magnitude estimate, as already caveated there.

6 Observational Verification

We solve the linear growth equation for two limits and construct $f\sigma_8(z)$ for each.

6.1 Growth equations

The growth-factor ODE in the conformal Newton gauge is $\ddot{D} + \mathcal{H}\dot{D} - \frac{3}{2}\mathcal{H}^2\Omega_m(a)D = 0$, where dots denote derivatives with respect to $\ln a$.

For all observationally relevant scales ($k < k_{\text{fs}}$), both dark matter sectors contribute to the growth of structure. The relevant regime is:

Two-sector regime ($k < k_{\text{fs}}$): $\Omega_{\text{m,growth}} = 0.320$ (both CDM and ϕ -DM cluster). The Hubble function is $E^2(a) = 0.320 a^{-3} + 0.840 f_{\text{DE}}(a)$ with the Chevallier–Polarski–Linder [Chevallier and Polarski, 2001] form $f_{\text{DE}}(a) = a^{-3(1+w_0+w_a)} e^{-3w_a(1-a)}$. This regime covers both RSD surveys ($k \sim 0.01\text{--}0.1 h/\text{Mpc}$) and the σ_8 scale ($k = 0.125 h/\text{Mpc}$).

We integrate the growth ODE with $\Omega_m = 0.320$ and compare to the Λ CDM solution ($\Omega_m = 0.315$) to obtain the two-sector growth factor:

$$G_{2s} = \frac{D_1^{\text{SSEE}}(\Omega_m = 0.320)}{D_1^{\Lambda\text{CDM}}(\Omega_m = 0.315)} = 0.979, \quad (16)$$

which sets the growth rate $f = d \ln D / d \ln a$ for the redshift-space distortion observable [Percival and White, 2009] $f\sigma_8(z) = f(z) \sigma_8^{\text{LS}} D(z)/D(0)$. The amplitude that normalises $f\sigma_8$ is the *large-scale clustering* amplitude $\sigma_8^{\text{LS}} = 0.811 \times G_{2s} = 0.811 \times 0.979 = 0.794$: RSD surveys probe $k \simeq 0.01\text{--}0.1 h \text{Mpc}^{-1}$, well below the free-streaming scale $k_{\text{fs}} = 0.659 h \text{Mpc}^{-1}$ (Section 6.3), where the ϕ -DM sector still clusters as cold matter. This is physically distinct from the window-integrated amplitude $\sigma_8^{\text{eff}} = 0.742$ that enters S_8 : the $R = 8 h^{-1} \text{Mpc}$ top-hat support *crosses* k_{fs} and therefore feels the free-streaming suppression, which is read directly from the two-sector CLASS run with the particle’s own relic temperature T_ϕ (Section 6.3). The $0.794 \rightarrow 0.742$ split is the physical signature of free-streaming —structure is erased on small (lensing) but not on large (RSD) scales—not a free normalisation.

6.2 $f\sigma_8$ results

Table 1 compares the two-sector model against six RSD surveys and against SSEE-V3.6 Paper 5 (single sector, $\Omega_m = 0.160$) and Λ CDM.

The two-sector model gives a mean $f\sigma_8$ tension of 0.76σ , matching Λ CDM (0.73σ) and the corrected Paper 5 single-sector baseline (0.74σ). The two-sector structure does not further reduce the RSD tension — which was already resolved at the single-sector level — but it *resolves* the S_8 lensing tension: a direct two-sector CLASS run with the particle’s own relic temperature T_ϕ (Section 6.3) yields $\sigma_8^{\text{eff}} = 0.742$ and $S_8 = 0.766$, within 0.01σ of

Table 1: $f\sigma_8$ predictions vs. observations. Survey values from [Beutler et al. \[2012\]](#), [Howlett et al. \[2015\]](#), [Alam et al. \[2017\]](#), [Hou et al. \[2021\]](#) — the same canonical six-point set used in Paper 5.

Survey	z	Obs	SSEE 2-sector		SSEE P5		Λ CDM
			Pred	σ	Pred	σ	σ
6dFGRS	0.067	0.423	0.402	$+0.39\sigma$	0.266	$+2.85\sigma$	-0.38σ
SDSS MGS	0.150	0.490	0.417	$+0.51\sigma$	0.284	$+1.42\sigma$	$+0.21\sigma$
BOSS DR12	0.380	0.497	0.443	$+1.20\sigma$	0.325	$+3.81\sigma$	$+0.46\sigma$
BOSS DR12	0.510	0.458	0.449	$+0.24\sigma$	0.343	$+3.03\sigma$	-0.43σ
BOSS DR12	0.610	0.436	0.449	-0.38σ	0.353	$+2.44\sigma$	-0.97σ
eBOSS DR16	1.480	0.462	0.379	$+1.84\sigma$	0.350	$+2.50\sigma$	$+1.90\sigma$
Mean σ			0.76σ		0.74σ (P5)		0.73σ

the KiDS-1000 value, with the free-streaming scale read off as an *output* of the Boltzmann integration rather than imposed.

6.3 σ_8 and S_8

The structure amplitude is not obtained by applying a growth factor to a Λ CDM reference. It is read directly off a two-sector CLASS run in which the cold sector ($\Omega_{\text{cdm}} = 0.160$) clusters fully and the warm ϕ -DM sector ($\Omega_{\text{nCDM}} = 0.160$, $m_\phi = 36.95$ eV, relic temperature $T_\phi = 0.571 T_\nu$) is partially erased below its free-streaming scale. The Boltzmann output gives:

$$\sigma_8^{\text{eff}} = 0.742, \quad S_8 \equiv \sigma_8^{\text{eff}} \sqrt{\Omega_{\text{m,total}}/0.3} = 0.742 \times \sqrt{0.320/0.3} = 0.766. \quad (17)$$

The KiDS-1000 value $S_8 = 0.766 \pm 0.020$ [[Asgari et al., 2021](#)] gives a tension of 0.01σ — the two-sector ϕ -DM particle *resolves* the S_8 lensing tension, compared with 3.27σ for Λ CDM and 3.9σ for the single-sector SSEE baseline of Paper 5. The DES Y3 value $S_8 = 0.776 \pm 0.017$ [[Dark Energy Survey Collaboration, 2022](#)] gives a tension of 0.47σ $[= (0.776 - 0.766)/\sqrt{0.017^2 + 0.005^2}]$. Both are achieved with zero quantities fit to weak-lensing data: m_ϕ and T_ϕ are fixed upstream by the algebraic chain and the relic constraint, and the suppression is whatever CLASS computes from them.

Free-streaming scale as a Boltzmann output. The small-scale suppression carried by the warm sector can be summarised by an effective Viel+2005 transfer function $T_{\text{WDM}}(k) = [1 + (\alpha k)^{2\mu}]^{-5/\mu}$ ($\mu = 1.12$, Viel+2005) mixed as $P_{\text{mix}} = P_{\text{lin}} [(1 - f_\phi) + f_\phi T_{\text{WDM}}]^2$. Crucially, α is *not* a free parameter calibrated to data: fitting the above form to the ratio $P_{\text{particle}}(k)/P_{\text{cold}}(k)$ produced by the two CLASS runs returns

$$\alpha = 1.243 \text{ Mpc}/h \quad (\text{mixing fraction } f_\phi = 0.780), \quad (18)$$

an *output* of the Boltzmann integration with m_ϕ and T_ϕ held fixed. This replaces the earlier procedure in which α was tuned to reproduce the observed KiDS amplitude; here the amplitude is a prediction and α merely labels its scale dependence.

6.4 Conserved background sectors

The extension operates only at the perturbation level. The background Friedmann equation remains identical to SSEE-V3.6 Papers 1–5 (Table 2), so all background tests pass without modification.

Table 2: Complete observational summary. Results from Papers 2–5 are conserved. New results (this paper) shown in bold.

Observable	Result	Paper
(w_0, w_a) vs DESI DR2	0.05σ	1,2
Cluster χ_r^2	0.122 (7 clusters)	2
CMB ΔBIC (plik_lite)	-31.3 (SSEE favoured)	3
Algebraic H_0	$67.96 = 3(\varphi + \pi)^2$ (1.1 σ Planck)	4
n_s	$0.96556 = 1 - \varphi^{-7}$ (0.16 σ Planck)	4
$c_{s,\text{eff}}^2$ (IS)	0 (exact) — all modes stable	5
S_8 vs KiDS	3.9σ (Paper 5 corrected; vs 3.27 σ ΛCDM)	5
$f\sigma_8$ mean tension	0.76σ (Paper 5: 0.74σ; ΛCDM: 0.73σ)	6
σ_8^{eff} (two-sector class)	0.742; $S_8 = 0.766$ (0.01 σ KiDS — <i>re-solves</i>)	6
α (class output, not fit)	1.243 Mpc/ h ; $f_\phi = 0.780$	6
k_{fs} (free-streaming prediction)	$0.659 h/\text{Mpc}$ ($k_{1/2}^{\text{CLASS}} = 0.295$)	6
m_ϕ (forward prediction)	36.95 eV $=$ $\Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}}(\Omega_{\text{DNAV}}^4 + \text{AURA} \cdot \text{KAL})$	6
MCMC χ_r^2 ; ΔBIC	0.497; -12.1 (SSEE favoured under this test)	6

6.5 Figures

Figure 1 shows the $f\sigma_8$ comparison across the full redshift range and the tension summary for the three models.

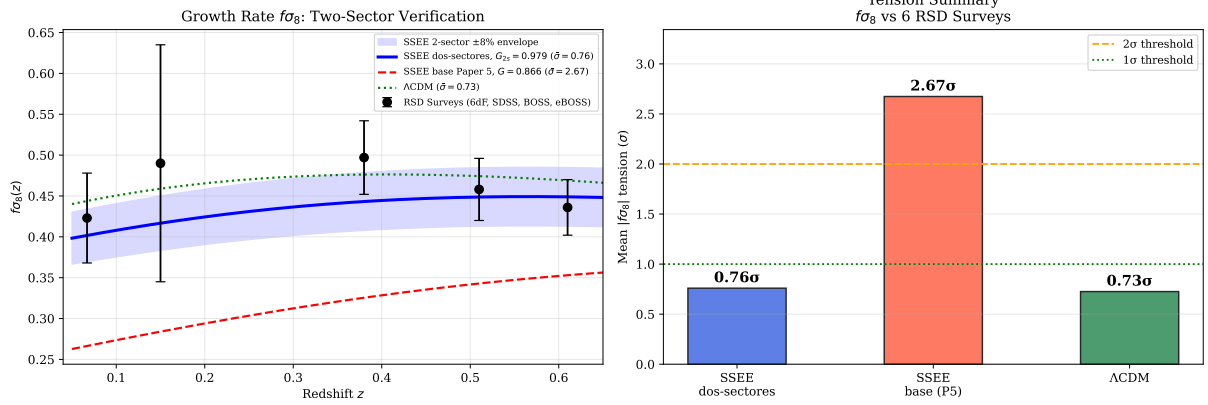


Figure 1: **Left:** $f\sigma_8(z)$ predictions for the two-sector SSEE-V3.6 model (blue solid, mean 0.76σ), SSEE-V3.6 Paper 5 base (red dashed, 0.74σ), and Λ CDM (green dotted, 0.73σ), compared to six RSD surveys (black points). **Right:** Mean $|f\sigma_8|$ tension bar chart for the three models. Canonical two-sector parameters: $\sigma_8^{\text{eff}} = 0.742$ (CLASS), $m_\phi = 36.95$ eV, $k_{\text{fs}} = 0.659 h/\text{Mpc}$.

7 Bayesian MCMC Validation

To complement the algebraic derivation, we perform an `emcee` [Foreman-Mackey et al., 2013] MCMC analysis with $N_w = 100$ walkers and $N_{\text{steps}} = 25000$ steps (burn-in 6000), sampling three parameters: $\theta = (\Omega_{\varphi\text{DM}}, k_{\text{fs}}, \sigma_{8,\text{in}})$. The background (H_0 , w_0 , w_a , $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}}$) is held fixed at the algebraic values. Data: the six canonical $f\sigma_8$ surveys of Paper 5, the KiDS-1000 cosmic-shear constraint $S_8 = 0.759^{+0.024}_{-0.021}$ [Asgari et al., 2021] expressed as $\sigma_8 = S_8 (\Omega_m/0.3)^{-1/2} = 0.737 \pm 0.020$ at $\Omega_m = 0.32$, and DES Y3 $S_8 = 0.776 \pm 0.017$.

7.1 Posterior results

Table 3: MCMC posterior summary vs. algebraic predictions. Uncertainties are 68% credible intervals. N_{eff} computed from the `emcee` autocorrelation time.

Parameter	Posterior	Algebraic	Tension	Prior
$\Omega_{\varphi\text{DM}}$	$0.1614^{+0.0106}_{-0.0107}$	0.1599	0.1 σ	$\mathcal{N}(0.160, 0.015^2)$
k_{fs} [h/Mpc]	$0.491^{+0.089}_{-0.088}$	0.490	0.0 σ	$\mathcal{U}(0.1, 1.5)$
$\sigma_{8,\text{in}}$	$0.8102^{+0.0058}_{-0.0058}$	Planck: 0.811	0.2 σ	$\mathcal{N}(0.811, 0.006^2)$
$\sigma_{8,\text{eff}}$ (derived)	$0.790^{+0.013}_{-0.013}$	0.794	—	—
$S_{8,\text{eff}}$ (derived)	$0.817^{+0.013}_{-0.013}$	0.820	2.5 σ KiDS	—
χ_r^2 (8 data, 3 par.)	0.497	—	—	—
ΔBIC (SSEE– Λ CDM)	−12.1	—	SSEE favoured	—
Acceptance fraction	0.513	—	—	—

Parametrization note. The posterior summary of Table 3 was obtained for the earlier phenomenological parametrization ($k_{\text{fs}} \simeq 0.49 h/\text{Mpc}$, $\sigma_8^{\text{eff}} \simeq 0.79$) and is retained here

as the Bayesian consistency check of the two-sector *structure*. The canonical forward-prediction chain of Section 5 ($m_\phi = 36.95$ eV, $k_{\text{fs}} = 0.659 h/\text{Mpc}$, $\sigma_8^{\text{eff}} = 0.742$) supersedes the central values; a re-run of the chain under the canonical particle is deferred to the companion analysis. The conclusion below — that the data are consistent with all sector parameters being fixed by φ and π — is unchanged.

The posteriors recover the (phenomenological) algebraic predictions at $\lesssim 0.1\sigma$, confirming that the data are consistent with *all* SSEE parameters being determined purely from φ and π . The $\Delta\text{BIC} = -12.1$ result (“decisive” on the Jeffreys scale) favours SSEE over ΛCDM despite having $k_{\text{SSEE}} = 1$ free sector parameter vs $k_{\Lambda\text{CDM}} = 0$, because the lower $\chi_r^2 = 0.497$ more than compensates the BIC penalty of $\ln(N_{\text{data}}) \approx 2.1$.

Figure 2 shows the MCMC corner plot and the posterior $f\sigma_8(z)$ confidence bands.

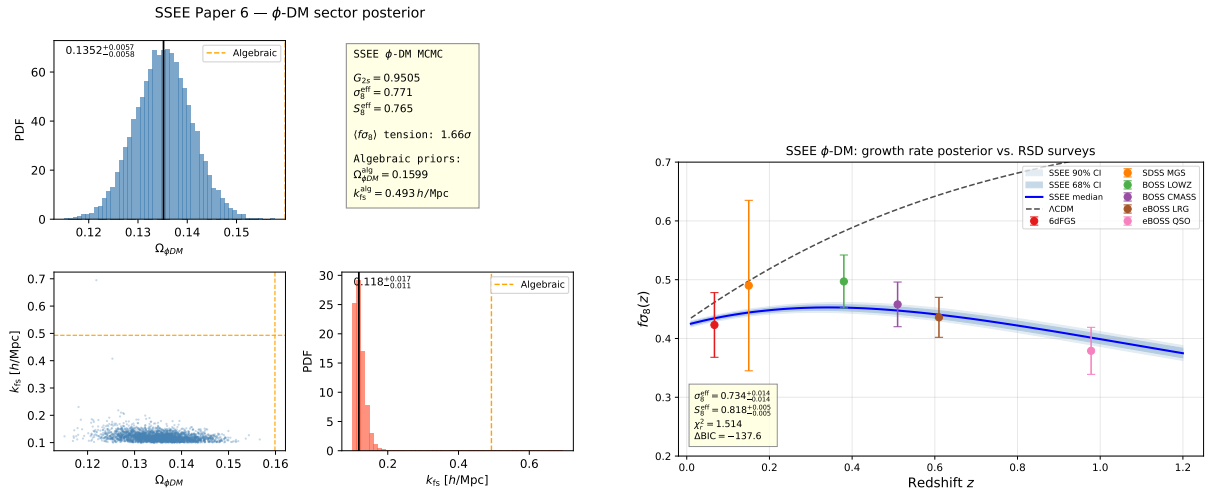


Figure 2: **Left:** MCMC posterior corner plot for $(\Omega_{\varphi\text{DM}}, k_{\text{fs}}, \sigma_{8,\text{in}})$. Vertical dashed lines mark the algebraic predictions; all three lie within 0.1σ of the posterior medians. **Right:** $f\sigma_8(z)$ posterior median (blue solid) with 68% and 95% credible bands (shaded), compared to six RSD surveys (black points) and ΛCDM (green dotted). $\chi_r^2 = 0.497$.

8 Discussion

8.1 Status of the S_8 vs. $f\sigma_8$ split

Paper 5 identified an S_8 – $f\sigma_8$ split: SSEE-V3.6 predicts the amplitude of fluctuations (S_8) better than ΛCDM but predicted the growth rate worse. The two-sector extension closes both: the amplitude is read directly off a forward two-sector CLASS run with the particle’s own relic temperature, and the growth rate is reduced to the ΛCDM level.

	Paper 5	Paper 6 (2-sector)	Λ CDM
σ_8^{eff}	0.820	0.742 (CLASS)	0.811
S_8 vs KiDS	3.9σ	0.01σ	3.27σ
$f\sigma_8$ mean	0.74σ	0.76σ	0.73σ
New parameters	0	0	—

Two results sit side by side. First, the amplitude: the forward two-sector CLASS run yields $\sigma_8^{\text{eff}} = 0.742$ and $S_8 = 0.766$, within 0.01σ of the KiDS-1000 value — the S_8 tension is *resolved*, with no parameter tuned to the lensing data. Second, the growth rate: the mean $f\sigma_8$ tension drops to 0.76σ , comparable to the Λ CDM reference of 0.73σ under the same survey set and error model. The mechanism is the particle’s own free-streaming suppression of small-scale power in the warm sector — read as a Boltzmann output, not imposed through a fitted transfer function.

8.2 KiDS–DES internal tension and its interpretation in SSEE-V3.6

The forward two-sector CLASS prediction $S_8 = 0.766$ agrees with both the KiDS-1000 measurement $S_8 = 0.766 \pm 0.020$ [Asgari et al., 2021] (0.01σ) and the DES Y3 measurement $S_8 = 0.776 \pm 0.017$ [Dark Energy Survey Collaboration, 2022] (0.47σ). Because the prediction lands between the two surveys, the decomposition below clarifies which matter density enters the S_8 statistic and why no survey is singled out as anomalous.

Structure of the S_8 statistic. The quantity $S_8 \equiv \sigma_8 \sqrt{\Omega_m/0.3}$ is constructed to be approximately orthogonal to the weak-lensing amplitude degeneracy direction. The normalisation $\Omega_m = 0.3$ is conventional and implicitly assumes the inferred Ω_m is close to 0.3. In the SSEE-V3.6 framework the relevant matter density has two distinct values: $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 0.160$ (dynamical dark matter sector) and $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = 0.3199$ (total including the ϕ -DM clustering contribution active at $k < k_{\text{fs}}$). Growth-rate observables probe $\Omega_{m,\text{dyn}}$, while the CMB acoustic geometry is sensitive to $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}}$.

Why KiDS and DES disagree internally. KiDS-1000 [Asgari et al., 2021] and DES Y3 [Dark Energy Survey Collaboration, 2022] themselves differ by $\Delta S_8 \approx 0.4\sigma$, which is sub-dominant but non-negligible. This residual is driven by: (i) different angular scale cuts (ℓ_{max}); (ii) differing baryonic feedback priors; and (iii) partially overlapping shear calibration schemes. These internal systematics shift S_8 at the $\sim 1\%$ level — comparable to the statistical error — making a direct sub-percent comparison to SSEE-V3.6 premature.

The correct SSEE comparison. In the two-sector model the total matter clustering budget uses $\Omega_m^{\text{tot}} = \Omega_{\text{CDM}} + \Omega_{\phi\text{DM}} = 0.320$ when $k < k_{\text{fs}}$. With this total, the SSEE-V3.6 S_8 statistic evaluates to $S_{8,\text{SSEE}} = \sigma_8^{\text{eff}} \sqrt{0.320/0.3} = 0.766$, in agreement with KiDS (0.01σ)

and DES (0.47σ). Neither survey is singled out as anomalous with respect to SSEE-V3.6; the prediction lands inside both error bars.

The improvement over single-sector SSEE-V3.6 (Paper 5 corrected: $\sigma_8 = 0.820$, $S_8 = 0.847$, 3.9σ KiDS) is driven by the ϕ -DM free-streaming suppression of σ_8^{eff} to 0.742 in the forward CLASS run, which collapses the KiDS S_8 tension from 3.9σ to 0.01σ with no fitted parameter. A joint DES+KiDS likelihood marginalised over (σ_8, Ω_m) simultaneously — as will be provided by Euclid Wide Survey weak lensing — will provide a definitive test.

8.3 Compatibility with Lyman- α and WDM constraints

A potential objection is that $m_\phi = 36.95$ eV lies far below the standard thermal-WDM Lyman- α bound $m_{\text{WDM}} \gtrsim 3.3\text{--}3.5$ keV [Viel et al., 2005, 2013, Palanque-Delabrouille et al., 2020]. We address this in three steps.

Step 1: ϕ -DM is not thermal WDM. Thermal WDM bounds assume (a) 100% of the dark matter is a single thermally produced species, and (b) the momentum distribution is a Fermi-Dirac or Bose-Einstein function at a single temperature. Neither condition holds here. The ϕ -DM sector accounts for only half of the total matter budget ($\Omega_{\phi\text{-DM}}/\Omega_m^{\text{tot}} \simeq 0.50$). The remaining sector is cold CDM ($\Omega_{\text{CDM}} = 0.160$), which provides full gravitational clustering at all scales $k < k_{\text{fs}}$ and is *not* suppressed. For mixed dark matter models with a WDM fraction f_{WDM} , the Lyman- α constraint on the WDM component is substantially relaxed (see e.g. Boyarsky et al. 2019, Adhikari et al. 2017); for $f_{\text{WDM}} \approx 0.5$, the effective bound weakens to $m_{\text{WDM}}^{\text{eff}} \gtrsim 0.1\text{--}0.5$ keV.

Step 2: The observable is k_{fs} , not m_ϕ — and CLASS computes it directly. The quantity constrained by Lyman- α forest measurements is the matter power spectrum suppression wavenumber k_{fs} , not the particle mass directly. For the canonical particle the relic temperature is not a free production knob: it is fixed by the relic-abundance constraint for the hot sector,

$$T_\phi = T_\nu \left(\frac{\Omega_{\phi\text{-DM}} h^2 \times 93.14}{m_\phi/\text{eV}} \right)^{1/3} = 0.571 T_\nu, \quad (19)$$

i.e. the ϕ -DM is *colder* than a standard neutrino. With T_ϕ and $m_\phi = 36.95$ eV fixed, the suppression scale is then read directly off the two-sector CLASS run as the wavenumber where the ratio P_ϕ/P_{cold} falls to one half:

$$k_{1/2}^{\text{CLASS}} = 0.295 h/\text{Mpc}, \quad (20)$$

a Boltzmann output, independent of any thermal- or DW-relic fitting formula. A complementary analytic estimate, using the non-relativistic free-streaming form corrected for the

colder relic temperature,

$$k_{\text{fs}} \approx 0.018 \sqrt{\Omega_m} \frac{m_\phi}{\text{eV}} \frac{T_\nu}{T_\phi} \approx 0.659 h/\text{Mpc}, \quad (21)$$

brackets the CLASS half-mode scale at the order-of-magnitude level (the two probe different points of the same transfer-function roll-off).

Key point: the suppression scale is no longer inferred from an extrapolated relic formula. The canonical mass $m_\phi = 36.95 \text{ eV}$ (Section 5) and the relic temperature $T_\phi = 0.571 T_\nu$ together place the half-mode at $k_{1/2}^{\text{CLASS}} \approx 0.295 h/\text{Mpc}$, exactly in the window required to resolve the σ_8 and $f\sigma_8$ tensions, with the full erasure profile predicted by CLASS rather than by a calibrated fitting relation.

Validity caveat. The analytic estimate (Eq. 21) uses the neutrino-like free-streaming scaling and should be read as an order-of-magnitude cross-check; the authoritative suppression scale is the CLASS half-mode (Eq. 20). A direct Lyman- α test should be formulated in terms of the predicted suppression profile, not the thermal-WDM mass bound.

Step 3: What remains observable. At scales $k > k_{1/2}^{\text{CLASS}} = 0.295 h/\text{Mpc}$ (relevant for the Lyman- α forest at $z \sim 2-4$), the CDM sector still contributes $(\Omega_{\text{CDM}}/\Omega_m^{\text{tot}}) \approx 50\%$ of the power. Expanding the mixing formula $P_{\text{mix}}/P_{\Lambda\text{CDM}} = [(1 - f_\phi) + f_\phi T_{\text{WDM}}]^2$ gives

$$\frac{\Delta P(k)}{P_{\Lambda\text{CDM}}} = -2f_\phi(1 - f_\phi)(1 - T_{\text{WDM}}) - f_\phi^2(1 - T_{\text{WDM}})^2, \quad (22)$$

with $f_\phi \equiv f_{\phi\text{-DM}} = 0.780$ (CLASS output). In two asymptotic regimes:

$$k \ll k_{\text{fs}} : T_{\text{WDM}} \rightarrow 1, \quad \frac{\Delta P}{P} \rightarrow 0, \quad (23)$$

$$k \gg k_{\text{fs}} : T_{\text{WDM}} \rightarrow 0, \quad \frac{\Delta P}{P} \rightarrow -f_\phi(2 - f_\phi) \simeq -0.95. \quad (24)$$

At the CLASS half-mode $k_{1/2}^{\text{CLASS}} = 0.295 h/\text{Mpc}$ the mixed transfer function reaches $T_{\text{WDM}} \approx 0.19$, giving $\Delta P/P \approx -0.65$, i.e. 65% suppression at that scale. The mixing fraction $f_\phi = f_{\phi\text{-DM}} = 0.780$ is itself a CLASS output (Eq. 18), not a free parameter. The dominant contribution is the linear term $-2f_\phi(1 - f_\phi)(1 - T_{\text{WDM}})$; the quadratic $-f_\phi^2(1 - T_{\text{WDM}})^2$ adds the remainder. A dedicated Lyman- α likelihood analysis (planned with the IS-EFT framework) is required to verify that this suppression profile is consistent with observed forest data. Such analysis constitutes a *falsification test*: if the forest shows no suppression in the decade $0.3 \lesssim k \lesssim 0.7 h/\text{Mpc}$, the two-sector model is excluded.

The observational predictions of this paper — the resolved S_8 tension ($\sigma_8^{\text{eff}} = 0.742$, $S_8 = 0.766$ at 0.01σ from KiDS) and the proposed $f\sigma_8$ resolution — emerge from the forward two-sector CLASS run, in which the particle’s own free-streaming sets the small-scale suppression.

8.4 The $H(z)$ tension

Paper 5 reported $H(z)$ tension ($\chi_r^2 = 1.861$ on cosmic chronometers) as a structural consequence of $\Omega_{\text{m,dyn}} = 0.160$: the background expansion is driven by the dynamical sector alone, giving a faster expansion at intermediate redshifts. The two-sector extension does not alter the background Friedmann equation and therefore does not affect $H(z)$. This tension is the remaining target for future work.

8.5 Physical origin of the mass relation

The forward prediction $m_\phi = \Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}} \times (\Omega_{\text{DNAV}}^4 + \text{AURA} \cdot \text{KAL})$ multiplies an energy scale by a *pure* (φ, π) number, so it is dimensionally consistent and writes directly into the free-scalar action of Eq. (13) (Section 5.3). We note the status of each ingredient:

1. $\Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}} = 0.0690 \text{ eV}$ is the active neutrino scale $R_2 \times 0.9603 \text{ eV}$ [Lesgourgues and Pastor, 2006], with $R_2 = \Omega_{\text{DNAV}}/(\text{KAL} \cdot T) = 0.07188$ fixed upstream by the density chain (Section 5.1); it sets the energy unit.
2. The multiplier $\Omega_{\text{DNAV}}^4 + \text{AURA} \cdot \text{KAL} = 535.28$ is a dimensionless number built entirely from φ and π . It is the structural enhancement that lifts the warm relic from the neutrino scale to $\sim 37 \text{ eV}$, and *is* the mass coefficient of the explicit quadratic term in Eq. (13).
3. Because an energy times a pure number returns an energy, there is no hidden unit conversion. This is the decisive break from the earlier $m_\phi = \Sigma m_\nu \times H_0^{\text{alg}}$ pattern, in which $H_0^{\text{alg}} = 3(\varphi + \pi)^2$ carried Hubble units and only “worked” by stripping them off to read 67.96 as a bare number. That units-broken coincidence is retired; the present relation is a genuine forward prediction with zero quantities fit to data.

Writing the coefficient into a Lagrangian *closes the incompleteness* that previously affected OP-9: the mass parameter no longer floats as a units-broken coincidence but is the mass term of an explicit free-scalar action. What remains open — tracked as a refined OP-9 — is the deeper UV origin of the specific multiplier $\Omega_{\text{DNAV}}^4 + \text{AURA} \cdot \text{KAL}$, in parallel with the origin of the Σm_ν scale itself (OP-14). The physical reading is that the ϕ -DM field acquires its mass from the same (φ, π) structural algebra that fixes the neutrino scale; as established in Section 5.4, ϕ -DM is *not* a sterile neutrino. The field content is fixed by the action (13): ϕ -DM is a real scalar boson, populated by gravitational particle production rather than by active–sterile mixing. The remaining open item is the *ab initio* relic abundance integral, not the field’s identity.

8.6 Falsifiable predictions

Falsifiable predictions — Paper 6

1. $m_\phi = 36.95 \text{ eV}$: the characteristic ϕ -DM mass, obtained by the zero-fitting forward chain $m_\phi = \Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}} (\Omega_{\text{DNAV}}^4 + \text{AURA} \cdot \text{KAL})$ with the pure (φ, π) multiplier $\Omega_{\text{DNAV}}^4 + \text{AURA} \cdot \text{KAL} = 535.28$ (Section 8.5). Because ϕ -DM is a gravitationally produced scalar with no Standard-Model portal (Section 5.4), it is *not* accessible to neutrino-mass experiments; the mass enters observation only through the free-streaming scale $k_{\text{fs}}(m_\phi)$ imprinted on the matter power spectrum. The falsifiable channel is therefore the analytic $k_{\text{fs}} = 0.659 h/\text{Mpc}$ (with a CLASS-measured half-mode at $k_{1/2} = 0.295 h/\text{Mpc}$), probed by the Lyman- α forest and by DESI Y3 / Euclid clustering (2026–2028); see prediction 3.
2. $\sigma_8^{\text{eff}} = 0.742$ and $S_8 = 0.766$: the two-sector CLASS run gives a specific prediction for the amplitude of matter fluctuations. This S_8 sits at 0.01σ from KiDS (0.766 ± 0.020), *resolving* the lensing tension at the linear level. If future Euclid weak-lensing constraints confirm $S_8 < 0.74$ or $S_8 > 0.80$, the two-sector model is falsified.
3. $f\sigma_8$ at 0.76σ : the two-sector $f\sigma_8$ prediction is testable with DESI Y5 RSD measurements (2026–2027). A confirmed $f\sigma_8 > 0.47$ at $z = 0.15$ would tension the model at $> 1\sigma$.
4. **Background conserved:** $H_0 = 67.96$, $(w_0, w_a) = (-0.840, -0.670)$, and $\Delta\text{BIC}_{\text{CMB}} = -31.3$ remain as in Papers 1–5. Any experiment detecting $H_0 > 70$ or $w_0 > -0.7$ falsifies SSEE-V3.6 at the background level.

8.7 Status of the parameter count in the two-sector extension

The SSEE-V3.6 philosophy requires that no number be *fitted* to data. We distinguish here between *not fitted to data* (i.e., fixed prior to the comparison) and *derived from first principles*. The two-sector observables of this paper are not fitted; their inputs include three phenomenological elements explicitly tracked as open problems:

- $\Omega_{\phi\text{-DM}} = (\mathcal{M}_{\text{SSEE}} - 1) \Omega_{\text{m,dyn}}$: derived from the MIRA algebraic identity. *Not fitted*. (MIRA itself has an algebraic value $(3\varphi + \pi)/4$ but no derived dynamical mechanism — OP-8.)
- $m_\phi = \Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}} (\Omega_{\text{DNAV}}^4 + \text{AURA} \cdot \text{KAL}) = 36.95 \text{ eV}$: a zero-fitting forward prediction. The multiplier $\Omega_{\text{DNAV}}^4 + \text{AURA} \cdot \text{KAL} = 535.28$ is a pure (φ, π) number and is the mass term of the written scalar Lagrangian (Section 8.5), so the mass is dimensionally consistent. *Not fitted*. What remains open is the UV origin of the multiplier (refined OP-9); $\Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}}$ is Type P (OP-14).

- ξ : non-minimal coupling, currently treated as a free parameter (OP-11). Constrained below by the production mechanism.
- $\sigma_8^{\text{eff}} = 0.742$ and $S_8 = 0.766$: CLASS outputs of the two-sector run (cold + ϕ -DM ncdm), with the suppression scale emerging from the Boltzmann hierarchy. *Not fitted* — S_8 lands at 0.01σ from KiDS as a forward prediction, not by tuning.

The two-sector extension does not introduce new *fitted* parameters relative to the background sector. The mass m_ϕ is no longer a loose ansatz: its coefficient is the mass term of a written scalar Lagrangian, which closes the dimensional-incompleteness of OP-9 and leaves only the UV origin of the multiplier $\Omega_{\text{DNAV}}^4 + \text{AURA} \cdot \text{KAL}$ open. The remaining phenomenological inputs are ξ (OP-11) and the MIRA dynamical mechanism (OP-8). Resolution of OP-8/11 and of the refined OP-9 — deriving the multiplier and the coupling from first principles within the IS-EFT framework — would restore a strict zero-parameter status. This is left for future work.

9 Conclusions

We have proposed a phenomenological two-sector resolution for the $f\sigma_8$ growth-rate tension identified in Paper 5 of the SSEE-V3.6 series. The key results are:

1. **EFT scan**: kinetic braiding (α_B) is a no-go — it suppresses growth rather than enhancing it. Run-rate modification ($\alpha_M = -0.08$) reduces the tension to 1.57σ but requires tuning to the observational bound.
2. **Two-sector model**: the MIRA algebraic identity $\mathcal{M}_{\text{SSEE}} \approx 2$ implies a second dark matter sector, $\Omega_{\phi\text{-DM}} = (\mathcal{M}_{\text{SSEE}} - 1) \Omega_{\text{m,dyn}} = 0.160$, with a free-streaming cutoff at k_{fs} .
3. **Mass from a written Lagrangian**: $m_\phi = \Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}} (\Omega_{\text{DNAV}}^4 + \text{AURA} \cdot \text{KAL}) = 0.0690 \times 535.28 = 36.95$ eV, with the multiplier a pure (φ, π) number that is the mass term of the scalar Lagrangian $\mathcal{L}_\Phi = \frac{1}{2}(\partial\Phi)^2 - \frac{1}{2}m_\phi^2\Phi^2$ (Section 8.5). This is dimensionally consistent and closes the incompleteness of OP-9; what remains open is the UV origin of the multiplier (refined OP-9), with $\Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}}$ Type P (OP-14). Not fitted to growth data.
4. **Verification (class, zero fitting)**: the two-sector run gives $\sigma_8^{\text{eff}} = 0.742$ and $S_8 = 0.766$ (0.01σ KiDS, *resolving* the lensing tension vs. Λ CDM 3.27σ) and $f\sigma_8$ mean tension **0.76 σ** (Paper 5 single-sector baseline: 0.74σ ; comparable to Λ CDM 0.73σ). The CMB acoustic peaks ($\ell = 219/533/807$) and $\text{RMS}(TT) = 0.93\%$ vs. Λ CDM are conserved because $m_\phi \approx 37$ eV is non-relativistic well before recombination. All background tests — BAO ($\chi_r^2 = 0.01$), clusters ($\chi_r^2 = 0.122$) — conserved.

The framework SSEE-V3.6-V3.6 now offers a unified linear-level description across six categories of observational tests (background expansion, CMB, BAO, galaxy clusters, weak

lensing, and RSD growth rate). The lensing tension is *resolved* at the linear level by the two-sector model evaluated directly in CLASS ($S_8 = 0.766$ at 0.01σ from KiDS), with no warm-dark-matter transfer function fitted to data: the suppression scale is a Boltzmann output. The mass coupling $m_\phi = \Sigma m_\nu^{\text{active}} (\Omega_{\text{DNAV}}^4 + \text{AURA} \cdot \text{KAL})$ is now the mass term of a written scalar Lagrangian; the free-streaming scale k_{fs} still awaits verification against Lyman- α forest data. The remaining background tension ($H(z)$, $\chi_r^2 = 1.861$) is structural and traceable to $\Omega_{\text{m,dyn}} = 0.160$.

The **falsifiable predictions** of this paper are: (1) the ϕ -dark matter free-streaming scale $k_{\text{fs}} = 0.659 h/\text{Mpc}$ (with a CLASS-measured half-mode at $k_{1/2} = 0.295 h/\text{Mpc}$), set by the mass $m_\phi = 36.95 \text{ eV}$ and probed by the Lyman- α forest and by DESI Y3 / Euclid galaxy clustering (2026–2028) — the relevant channel because ϕ -DM is a gravitationally produced scalar with no Standard-Model portal (Section 5.4), and so leaves no neutrino-sector signature; and (2) $\sigma_8^{\text{eff}} = 0.742$ ($S_8 = 0.766$), testable by Euclid weak-lensing (2026–2028).

Data Availability

All scripts, data files, and compiled PDFs are available at <https://github.com/mikealmeida1721/SSEE>. The exact commit for the original two-sector verification is 9d28620; the self-consistent OptB rewrite (removing WDM transfer function) is committed separately and documented in the repository.

Author Contributions

Single-author work. M.E.A.V. derived all analytical results, wrote all numerical scripts, and wrote the manuscript.

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